

WE THOUGHT HE WAS JOKING

Story Bible — Version 2

Genre

Psychological Thriller

Mystery

Drama

Theme

Not every tragedy has a villain.

Sometimes...

It only takes one terrible misunderstanding.

Main Characters

The Narrator

Age: 22

The quiet one.

Always observing.

Rarely speaks.

He's the person being interviewed months after the incident.

He blames himself every single day.

Unknown to everyone else...

He has recently been experiencing occasional hallucinations brought on by prolonged stress and severe sleep deprivation. He has hidden this from his friends because he believes he'll "get over it."

The Friend (Victim)

Age: 22

The funniest person in every room.

Makes crime jokes.

Death jokes.

Disappearance jokes.

Everyone laughs because...

That's just who he is.

The problem is...

Nobody can tell when he's joking anymore.

Roommate

Age: 23

Lives with the Friend.

Has heard every joke hundreds of times.

Whenever someone gets worried, he immediately says:

"Relax."

"He's always like this."

Without realizing it...

He slowly teaches everyone to ignore the warning signs.

Friend's Girlfriend

Age: 22

Knows the Friend's emotional side.

They've been arguing more recently.

Not because they hate each other...

Because neither knows how to communicate anymore.

Neighbor

Age: 35

Lives next door.

Knows none of them personally.

Only knows their voices.

The arguments.

The laughter.

The music.

He accidentally becomes the only outside witness.

Trailer

Months later..

The Narrator sits in front of a camera.

He struggles to speak.

He asks:

"Should I sit here?"

"Which camera do I look at?"

He asks for a minute.

He drinks water.

Then finally says...

"I've replayed that night so many times..."

"He told us exactly what he was going to do."

"We just thought he was joking."

Cut to black.

Episode 1

Introduce everyone.

The Friend constantly makes disturbing jokes.

Examples:

"If I ever commit a crime..."

"You better delete our chats."

Everyone laughs.

Especially the Narrator.

End.

Episode 2

The Girlfriend's perspective.

She notices the Friend changing.

Sleeping less.

Laughing less.

Thinking more.

But whenever she asks...

He immediately turns everything into another joke.

Audience starts wondering...

Is something actually wrong?

Episode 3

The Roommate's perspective.

He explains that this has been happening for years.

"He always says stuff like that."

"He just likes making people uncomfortable."

This convinces the audience...

The Friend really is just dramatic.

Near the end...

The Narrator quietly asks:

"...Do you ever think he's serious?"

The Roommate laughs.

"No."

Episode 4

Neighbor's perspective.

He hears another argument.

Nothing unusual.

The audience thinks...

This is just another fight.

But one small detail changes.

For the first time...

The Friend isn't shouting.

He's speaking calmly.

The Neighbor notices.

He almost knocks.

Instead...

He goes back inside.

Episode 5

The Final Night.

Everyone gathers.

The Friend finally stops joking.

He says...

"I'm serious this time."

Nobody believes him.

Because...

He's said similar things hundreds of times.

The conversation becomes emotional.

The Narrator hasn't slept properly for days.

Throughout previous episodes, tiny clues hinted at this:

He rubs his eyes.

Looks at empty corners.

Pauses mid-conversation.

Nobody notices.

Including the audience.

Suddenly...

The Narrator sees someone standing in the hallway.

A dark figure.

Watching everyone.

The figure slowly moves.

The Narrator panics.

The audience sees the same figure.

So they believe it's real too.

The Friend walks toward him.

Trying to calm him down.

The Narrator mistakes the movement.

He grabs a heavy decorative object nearby.

Instinct.

Fear.

He swings.

The figure disappears.

The Friend falls.

Silence.

The object slips from the Narrator's hand.

Everyone freezes.

The Narrator slowly looks back toward the hallway.

It's empty.

There was never anyone there.

Aftermath

Nobody speaks.

The Neighbor finally knocks.

The Girlfriend starts crying.

The Roommate calls emergency services.

The Narrator cannot process what just happened.

The CCTV

Weeks later...

The Narrator watches the CCTV.

There is no dark figure.

Only...

Him.

Standing still.

Looking into an empty hallway.

Then suddenly...

Swinging.

The Friend collapses.

The Narrator realizes...

The person he tried to protect everyone from...

Never existed.

Final Interview

The interviewer asks...

"What do you think happened?"

Long silence.

The Narrator can't answer.

Instead...

He says...

"I keep asking myself the same question."

"If I had just slept."

"If he had stopped joking."

"If someone had believed him."

"If someone had knocked."

"...Maybe he'd still be here."

Long pause.

"I don't think one person killed him."

"I think..."

"We all lost him."

Fade to black.

Ending Message

Nobody planned a murder.

Nobody wanted anyone to die.

The tragedy wasn't created in one moment.

It was created through hundreds of tiny moments...

Where everyone thought,

"It's probably nothing."